

BEAK VARIETY

A bird's beak reflects its diet. For example, the spoonbill sweeps its beak through water like a shovel to locate food. The sharp beak of a woodpecker is perfect for chiselling off tree bark to reach insects.



**SWEEPING
IN WATER**



**CATCHING
FLYING INSECTS**



**PICKING UP
SURFACE PREY**



**TEARING
MEAT**



**CUTTING
FRUIT**



**CHISELLING
WOOD**



**STABBING AND
SPEARING PREY**



**PROBING MUD
AND SAND**



**MULTI-
PURPOSE**

BABY BIRDS

Family life is usually a brief but very busy period. Most birds lay their eggs in a nest. Hatchlings need constant feeding and grow very quickly. Once baby birds have mastered flying, they leave the nest for good.



1 EGGS

Most birds sit on their eggs to keep them at the right temperature.



2 HATCHLINGS

Blind and naked, the hatchlings rely on their parents for care and food.



3 FIVE-DAY-OLD CHICKS

Now called "nestlings", the chicks' eyes open and small "pin" feathers develop.



4 NINE-DAY-OLD CHICKS

The nestlings are now nearly feathered and their eyes are wide open.



5 READY TO FLEDGE

At two weeks, the fledglings are ready to leave the nest and learn to fly.

PIGEONS AND DOVES

With their round bodies, small bobbing heads, and short beaks, pigeons and doves are easily recognized.



**MOURNING
DOVE**



**SPECKLED
PIGEON**



**SOUTHERN
CROWNED
PIGEON**

PARROTS AND COCKATOOS

These vibrantly coloured tropical birds are well known for their intelligence.



**OLIVE-HEADED
LORIKEET**



**RED-FAN
PARROT**

BLUE-CROWNED HANGING PARROTS



HUMMINGBIRDS AND SWIFTS

The tiny, acrobatic hummingbirds are among the smallest of all bird species. Swifts, known for their speed, can be recognized by their very short legs and small feet.



**BRAZILIAN
RUBY**



**LUCIFER
HUMMINGBIRD**



**WHITE-THROATED
SWIFT**

KINGFISHERS

Brightly coloured kingfishers and their relatives are mostly "sit-and-wait" predators, swooping down from perches to snatch prey.



**PIED
KINGFISHER**



**LAUGHING
KOOKABURRA**



**JAMAICAN
TODY**



**WHITE-THROATED
BEE-EATER**

DUCKS, GEESE, AND SWANS

Found across the world, these water birds have webbed feet and flattened beaks. Nearly all species nest on or beside the water.



BLACK SWAN



BAR-HEADED GOOSE

**PLUMED
WHISTLING DUCK**



KING EIDER DUCK



BAIKAL TEAL

LONG-TAILED DUCK

CRANES

Graceful cranes and their many relatives live in both dry and wet habitats. Cranes perform impressive courtship displays.



CORNCRAKE



**AMERICAN
COOT**



**LITTLE
BUSTARD**



**GREY-CROWNED
CRANE**



**PURPLE
GALLINULE**

WADERS, GULLS, AND AUKS

Auks, such as puffins, are sea swimmers, while gulls hunt on the wing. Waders feed along muddy shores.



HEERMAN'S GULL



**EURASIAN
OYSTERCATCHER**



**ATLANTIC
PUFFIN**



**COMMON
REDSHANK**



PIED AVOCET

PERCHING BIRDS

Most birds are perching birds – their unique feet can grip even very slender branches. Many species are songbirds.



**BARN
SWALLOW**



**EASTERN
YELLOW ROBIN**



**LESSER BIRD
OF PARADISE**



**EURASIAN
SKYLARK**



**YELLOW
WARBLER**



DUNCOCK



WRENTIT

**PARROTS CAN COPY MANY
SOUNDS, INCLUDING HUMAN
WORDS AND LAUGHTER**